



English H+ Practice Set Answer Sheet

Writer: Vicky 10 (12)

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Range: City of Glass and Vocabulary 3&4

Note: Review Practices are UNOFFICIAL sources of reference and do NOT include or hint at questions in the actual exam!

MCQs

1. C
2. C
3. C
4. D
5. C
6. C
7. B
8. C
9. C
10. C

FRQs:

1. Answer Key Points:

- Start: Grieving, isolated writer living through pseudonym (William Wilson).
- Catalyst: Taking on "Paul Auster" identity (initial thrill/replacement).
- Obsession: Stalking Stillman Sr. replaces writing/life; meticulous note-taking (red notebook).
- Reality Blurring: Meeting real Paul Auster undermines his assumed identity; Stillman Sr.'s bizarre behavior defies logic.
- Loss of Control: Notebook becomes chaotic/unintelligible; surveillance becomes meaningless/compulsive.
- Physical Deterioration: Neglects hygiene, home, health; lives on streets.
- Breakdown: Inability to distinguish self/role; language fails; retreats into silence/oblivion; disappears. (Look for specific visual cues: art style changes, panel fragmentation, Quinn's appearance).

2. Answer Key Points (Choose 2 themes):

- Identity: Use of mirrors/reflections; similar character designs (Quinn, Austers, Stillmans); fragmented panels during identity crises; isolation within frames; visual doubling motifs. How it enhances: Visually shows the instability and dissolution of self.
- Reality vs. Illusion: Stark chiaroscuro (extreme light/dark) creating uncertainty;

distorted perspectives; dreamlike sequences; panels showing observation/ subjectivity (e.g., binocular POV); surreal symbols (falling figures, Tower of Babel). How it enhances: Creates a constant sense of unease and visual ambiguity, mirroring Quinn's unreliable perception.

- Language/Failure: Visual depiction of Peter Jr.'s unique speech bubbles; Quinn's handwriting degrading in the notebook; chaotic scribbles replacing words; visual metaphors for language (mazes, towers); silent panels/sequences. How it enhances: Shows the breakdown of communication and meaning visually, beyond just the text.
- Alienation: Wide shots of tiny figures in vast cityscapes; characters framed alone within panels or surrounded by negative space; empty streets; lack of eye contact between characters; use of shadows obscuring faces. How it enhances: Visually conveys profound loneliness, disconnection, and the isolating nature of the urban environment.

3. Answer Key Points:

- Uses Tropes: Wrong number/case initiation; troubled detective (Quinn's grief); mysterious client (Peter Jr.); potential villain (Stillman Sr.); surveillance; clues (notebook); femme fatale (Virginia - somewhat).
- Subverts/Rejects Tropes:
 - The Mystery: Has no clear solution; the "threat" (Stillman Sr.) is ambiguous; clues lead nowhere or become meaningless.
 - The Detective: Quinn is profoundly incompetent as a detective; his investigation causes his destruction instead of resolution; he lacks the traditional detective's control and insight.
 - Resolution: No closure; the case isn't "solved" in any traditional sense; justice isn't served; the detective fails utterly and is consumed.
 - Purpose: Explores philosophical questions (identity, language, reality) rather than delivering a satisfying crime plot.
 - Genre Expectations: Replaces action and deduction with obsession, paranoia, and psychological collapse.

4. Answer Key Points:

- Quinn: Author of detective fiction under a pseudonym (William Wilson). Creates the "Paul Auster" PI persona. Tries to "author" the reality of the case through his notebook (fails). Becomes a character lost in a narrative he can't control.
- Real Paul Auster (Character): A writer within the story. Represents the "source" of Quinn's assumed identity. Indifferent to Quinn's plight, highlighting the separation between author and character.

- Paul Auster (Original Author): Created the source novel. His presence as a character blurs lines between creator and creation. The story explores themes he wrote about.
- Karasik & Mazzucchelli (Adapters): "Authors" of the graphic novel version. Their choices (visual style, condensation, emphasis) reinterpret Auster's work, demonstrating adaptation as a form of authorship/creation.
- Commentary: The graphic novel suggests identities are constructed like stories (Quinn's personas). Authorship is unstable (pseudonyms, adaptations). Trying to control a narrative (life or story) can lead to failure and dissolution. Creation involves layers of identity and interpretation.